

Unstructured Postal Address Removal and Agent Considerations



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The mission of the PMPG is to:

- Take stock of payments market practices across regions.
- Discuss, explain, and document market practice issues, including possible commercial impact.
- Recommend market practices, covering end-to-end transactions.
- Propose best practice, business responsibilities and rules, message flows, consistent implementation of ISO messaging standards and exception definitions.
- Ensure publication of recommended best practices.
- Recommend payments market practices in response to changing compliance requirements.

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Introduction



In November 2026, the unstructured Postal Address is being removed from the ISO 20022 Payment messages.

This will apply not only for the Party Postal Addresses, such as Debtor and Creditor, but also for all the Agents within the payment.

It is important for FIs who are deriving Bank chains and Agents within their payment engines to ensure that they are formatting the Agents in a way which will comply with the removal of the unstructured Postal Address.

Agent Formatting



Where possible, a BIC should be used to identify an Agent within a Payment.

However, there are some instances where a BIC alone cannot be used to derive the correct Branch to route a payment to in order to complete the final credit to the Creditor's account and, therefore, a National Clearing Code or an IBAN may be required for correct routing of the payment.

There may also be cases where the Financial Institution within the payment chain does not have a BIC, and therefore a National Clearing Code is relied upon in order to route the payment.

This paper outlines the general formatting rules for providing Agent information (with a special focus on Creditor Agent) in order to ensure STP of payment processing.

Options within this paper should be considered in conjunction with the specific Scheme or domestic rules.

Creditor Agent Formatting



Option 1 – Only a BIC provided at Creditor Agent level

A

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <BICFI>BANKAAAAXXX</BICFI>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>

  <CdtrAcct>
    <Id>
      <IBAN>GB47BANK20325366664444</IBAN>
    </Id>
  </CdtrAcct>
```

- In the above example, a Head Office BIC (optional LEI – in line with CPMI Data requirements) has been provided at the Creditor Agent level.
- To ensure the correct routing of this payment, an IBAN has been provided at the Creditor Account level.
- Please note that IBANs are used by 89 countries globally, are mandated in some countries, and provide a standardized, internationally recognized unique identifier of a customer's bank account.
- The presence of the IBAN will help route the payment to the correct Branch within the Bank.

B

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <BICFI>BANKAAAABRC</BICFI>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>

  <CdtrAcct>
    <Id>
      <Othr>
        <Id>66664444</Id>
      </Othr>
    </Id>
  </CdtrAcct>
```

- In the above example, a BIC (optional LEI) has been provided at a Branch level, which will help the routing of the payment to the correct Branch.
- This has been accompanied with an account number as IBANs are not necessarily always available.

Creditor Agent formatting

Option 2 – BIC Supplemented by National Clearing Code

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <BICFI>BANKAAAAXXX</BICFI>
    <ClrSysMmbld>
      <ClrSysId>
        <Cd>GBDSC</Cd>
      </ClrSysId>
      <Mmbld>203253</Mmbld>
    </ClrSysMmbld>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>

<CdtrAcct>
  <Id>
    <Othr>
      <Id>66664444</Id>
    </Othr>
  </Id>
</CdtrAcct>
```

- In the above example, a Head Office BIC (optional LEI – in-line with CPMI Data requirements) has been provided at the Creditor Agent level and this has been supplemented with the National Clearing Code.
- When using this option of data formatting, the National Clearing Code does **not** need to be supplemented with a Name and Address because the BIC is present.
- Therefore, the HVPS+ rule “***HVPSPlus_Agents_FormaRule*** - Either BIC or (Name and Postal Address) must be present and both can be present. Other elements remain optional” is met.

Creditor Agent formatting



Option 3 – National Clearing Code only (No BIC exists or cannot be derived)

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <ClrSysMmbld>
      <ClrSysId>
        <Cd>GBDSC</Cd>
      </ClrSysId>
      <Mmbld>203253</Mmbld>
    </ClrSysMmbld>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
    <Nm>BANK A</Nm>
    <PstlAdr>
      <StrtNm>SHORT STREET</StrtNm>
      <BldgNb>1</BldgNb>
      <TwnNm>LONDON</TwnNm>
      <Ctry>GB</Ctry>
    </PstlAdr>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>
```

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <ClrSysMmbld>
      <ClrSysId>
        <Cd>USABA</Cd>
      </ClrSysId>
      <Mmbld>075644534</Mmbld>
    </ClrSysMmbld>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
    <Nm>BANK B</Nm>
    <PstlAdr>
      <StrtNm>PARK AVENUE</StrtNm>
      <BldgNb>16</BldgNb>
      <PstCd>10022</PstCd>
      <TwnNm>NEW YORK</TwnNm>
      <Ctry>US</Ctry>
    </PstlAdr>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>
```

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <ClrSysMmbld>
      <ClrSysId>
        <Cd>USPID</Cd>
      </ClrSysId>
      <Mmbld>0001</Mmbld>
    </ClrSysMmbld>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
    <Nm>BANK C</Nm>
    <PstlAdr>
      <StrtNm>WALL STREET</StrtNm>
      <BldgNm>HIGH TOWER</BldgNm>
      <PstCd>10005</PstCd>
      <TwnNm>NEW YORK</TwnNm>
      <Ctry>US</Ctry>
    </PstlAdr>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>
```

```
<CdtrAgt>
  <FinInstnId>
    <ClrSysMmbld>
      <ClrSysId>
        <Cd>FEYS</Cd>
      </ClrSysId>
      <Mmbld>0000</Mmbld>
    </ClrSysMmbld>
    <LEI>5493001KJTIIGC8Y1R12</LEI>
    <Nm>BANK D</Nm>
    <PstlAdr>
      <StrtNm>HANAZAKICHO</StrtNm>
      <BldgNb>7</BldgNb>
      <TwnNm>NARITA-SHI</TwnNm>
      <Ctry>JP</Ctry>
    </PstlAdr>
  </FinInstnId>
</CdtrAgt>
```

- In the above examples, a National Clearing Code (optional LEI – in-line with CPMI Data requirements) has been provided at the Creditor Agent level.
- When a BIC is **not** present, the HVPS+ rule kicks in (*for many Market Infrastructures), which will mandate the presence of the Name and Address “HVPS+ Agents_FormalRule - Either BIC or (Name and Postal Address) must be present and both can be present. Other elements remain optional”

Sourcing Address for Agents



There are Industry Reference files/directories which provide National Clearing Codes and Routing Information, such as the below examples:

Region	File/Dataset	Maintained by	Purpose
GB UK	EISCD (Extended ISCD)	Pay.UK	Sort codes, branch data, scheme participation [wearepay.uk]
US US	ABA Routing Number Directory / FedACH/Fedwire lists	ABA / Federal Reserve	Routing numbers for ACH & wires
AU Australia	BSB Directory	AusPayNet	Bank-State-Branch codes, routing by institution [auspaynet.com.au]
DE Germany	BLZ (Bankleitzahl) directory	Bundesbank	Bank/branch identifiers
IN India	IFSC directory	RBI	Routing for RTGS/NEFT
CA Canada	Transit Number / MICR directory	Payments Canada	Branch routing codes
MX Mexico	CLABE directory	Banco de México	Account + routing identification
ZA South Africa	Bank Branch Code lists	PASA	EFT routing
JP Japan	Financial Institutions code (BOJ code)	Bank of Japan/FXYCS	Domestic clearing routing
CN China	CNAPS code directory	PBoC	Interbank routing

However, not all Directories have been updated to provide Postal Address data in a format that it is needed in order to populate a Hybrid or Structured Postal Address by November 2026.

Therefore, the **Bank Directory Plus** is an option to be utilized to source Structured Postal Address information required to populate Agent Postal Address elements when required.

The **Bank Directory Plus*** provides National Clearing Codes and associated Postal Address information for over 150 Countries.

Sources used to populate Name and Address information within the Bank Directory Plus utilise the following hierarchy:

- **BIC Directory 2018**
 - If the record is linked to a BIC, then the Name and Address are taken from BIC Directory 2018.
 - The only exception is for Austria. For Austria, Swift takes the data from the National Provider file (also for the BIC records).
- **National Code data set**
 - If the record has a National ID but no BIC, then the Name and Address are taken from National Provider.
- **CHIPS UID**
 - For CHIPS records that have no BIC or National ID, the Name and Address are taken from the CHIPS file

* The Bank Directory Plus will soon be replaced by "SwiftRef Identifiers Directory". The SwiftRef Portfolio evolution is introducing the new Identifiers Directory that is replacing the legacy Bank Directory Plus. Learn more about the new Identifiers Directory: [SwiftRef Bank Directory Plus](#) / [Swift](#)